



Raumlaissi Jaaritukksi

Tall Tales from 19th Century Finland

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Raumlaissi Jaarituksi: Tall Tales From 19th Century Finland

Having been established in 1442, Rauma is the fifth oldest city in Finland. It is located on the west coast in the Satakunta province. Since its inception, Rauma has been a major port and trade hub. This relationship with greater Europe has brought not just goods and cargo to Finland's shores but also linguistic influence. The Rauma dialect is known to be one of the strongest dialects of Finnish with influences from Swedish, English, Estonian, French, Russian, and German due to the town's seafaring culture. The dialect is so strong that many prefer to refer to it as the Rauma language. The stronger, historical form of Rauma language is used to this day in city signage and is spoken by a small population in the area. The language is maintained and revitalized by *Nortamo Seor* ("The Nortamo Society"), named after the prominent Rauma author Frans Hjalmar Nortamo.

Nortamo wrote songs and several collections of short stories in the Rauma dialect. The first volume *Raumlaissi jaarituksi* was published in 1898 in Rauma's yacht club journal and contained a series of humorous tall tales about the lives of Rauma residents. Aside from being a pivotal work of Rauma literature and culture, it is also the very first piece of dialectal Finnish literature whatsoever. Publishing in dialects was strictly banned from the standardization of the Finnish language until Nortamo's writings. None of Nortamo's writings have been rendered in English, and they are in the public domain.

The purpose of this project is to translate "Antonim bäev" ("Anton's Name Day"), the first short story in the collection, into English for the very first time so that it may be enjoyed by a wider audience. The original source text for "Anton's Name Day" can be found in Appendix A for reference. Grammatical primers published by The Nortamo Society were used as aides in the translation process. Those primers were also translated to English and included in Appendix B.

Anton's Name Day

I remember that Anton's name day¹ from 40 years ago like it was yesterday. Anders Anton Kringelin was alive back then, and good gracious he's still kickin'. He was livin' at that time on the big cross street² opposite Simeli's. He was a nice fella, though he was a bit sickly. Anton's name day fell that year on a Wednesday. Come Tuesday evening, Tasala Vilkku dropped by and said, "Hey, as you know, tomorrow's Anton's name day, and Kringelin ought to be woken up in the mornin' a bit more festively than usual."

"Yes, he certainly does," I said, pondering how it'd be done. "Normally we'd put on a show, and if Hakkri Iiro'd blow into his clarinet and you'd play your fiddle, we'd have ourselves quite the party."

But my idea wasn't good enough for Vilkku. That boy always had a different way of seein' things, and just as soon as I'd finished, he started lookin' at me like a church beggar and said, "A show! Yes, usually we'd have a show. But do you think that's festive? Not at all. We oughta shoot instead. I think Kringelin oughta be woken up tomorrow mornin' with a couple of blasts."

"Well, well, then that's the way it should be," I conceded. "Let's shoot. But where are we gonna get our guns? I'm definitely not comin' along if you're just gonna shoot alone. I want a go at it too, and I bet Hakkri Iiro would wanna join in once the shootin' gets goin'."

Vilkku then asked, "Who said anythin' about shootin' a gun? You think it'd be festive if someone on your name day came to your window with a gun? How do you know he'd wake up at the gun's blast?"

"Then what'll we shoot with?" I wondered.

¹ A name day is a celebration of a person's name on a specific day of the year.

² The official name of the street is *Isopoikkikatu*.

“With a cannon, of course! That way we won’t need any liros, and it’ll all just work. You bring Minerva’s³ cannon here at the crack of dawn, and when I load it, I guarantee it’ll be louder than three guns’ blasts or even more when it goes off. You know that Minerva’s cannon’s a beast—I’ve shot with him before.

“Well, you certainly are a prankster,” I said, “but your plan ain’t that crazy. So yeah, I’ll deliver that cannon here in good time. When the first load of planks comes into the harbor tomorrow mornin’, I’ll jump on board, head down to Minerva’s lower decks, stick the cannon in a sack, and make it home again on the back of the farmer’s horse. It’ll be just like I’ve done it before.

And that I did. Minerva’s cannon was already with us before five o’ clock the next mornin’, and Vilkku started to load it up immediately. That boy stuck heaps of gunpowder in there. So much that I feared the whole celebration was gonna be a bit too extravagant. On top of the powder he beat and tamped down some wadding⁴ so there wouldn’t be any room left. I tried to restrain him, but do you think it helped? Of course not. He beat the fillin’ into the cannon with a hammer and a wooden block, and he spit into the mix so it’d get packed tight. I hadn’t been involved much with cannon loadin’, but I understood anyway that there was gonna be a festive bang when it went off since there was so much powder in there, as I said, and Vilkku had beaten the fillin’ all the way to the mouth. You shoulda seen how proud Vilkku was when he’d finished the job. His eyes glistened like tin buttons when he felt with his fingers that the wadding was packed tight. Then he grabbed the whole contraption under his arm, and we left around half past five in the mornin’ to bring it to Kringelin’s place. Soft as a whisper we made our way to the kitchen so Anton wouldn’t know a thing. We could hear the boy snorin’ in the other room. Not a

³ Minerva is the name of a cargo ship.

⁴ The technical term and more direct translation is *oakum*.

soul was movin' in the whole house except for the servant girl. She'd lit the fireplace and was tendin' to the coffee pot. But I said to her, "Excuse me, girl, would you move a bit away from there? We also have some business to do."

The servant girl gave us a good stare, but she stepped away so Vilkku could put his cannon into position on the fireplace. He adjusted it this way and that for quite a while, but finally it was to his liking. I told him it looked very festive on the fireplace lookin' toward Anton's room. There was nothin' left to do but get the shootin' underway. I thought to myself that Vilkku would want the honor for himself, since he'd loaded it after all. And I won't deny I was a little afraid of the cannon blast. I snuck gradually behind the servant girl, but I didn't stand there long. Vilkku ignited a wooden shaving, came over to me, and said: "Hey, Kalkke, I hope it's not a bother, but you're gonna have to fire that there cannon, since I loaded it up."

Oh, I understood this wasn't a question of being a bother. Vilkku and I both feared the blast. But in that same moment I remembered standin' in front of the city hall, gettin' commended for my bravery for puttin' out the fires back when the English burned Rauma harbor.⁵ And when I remembered that, I grit my teeth, grabbed the lit shaving from Vilkku's hand, and stuck it in the flash pan.

Then boom! Good gracious, it went off! It was a festive display! The coffee pot flew God knows where, the servant girl stood speechless with her eyes wide open, and all the house windows shattered into pieces. But Vilkku quickly snatched the cannon under his arm, and we made our escape with Vilkku in front and myself in tow. When we'd gotten out of the gate, we noticed the neighbors' windows were broken too. That lit a fire under us! Even so, I looked back,

⁵ Rauma was burned by the British navy on July 2, 1855 as part of the Åland War.

saw Kringelin stick his head out of the empty window frame, and heard him shout, “Yeah, I see you scoundrels!” I’d barely heard him when we’d fled behind the Palotonti⁶ storehouses to hide.

But that Vilkku was quite a rascal! Both of us were, if I do say so myself. You know what we did? Hoo-ee! We loaded that cannon up again and got it ready—Vilkku was quite a master at that—then we went a second time to Kringelin’s place, set the cannon in its old spot, and blasted it a second time. Except this time we didn’t flee but went straight to Anton’s room, and Kringelin entertained us and thanked us a bit too many times for the festive awakening. And festive blasts they were. That’s what everyone who heard them said.

It really did happen like that. I remember that day clearly. That was back when we could still have a little fun. Try doin’ somethin’ festive nowadays and you’ll have the authorities breathing down your neck in no time.

Historical Context

Anders Anton Kringelin, perhaps Nortamo’s most well-known namesake, was really known as Knut Anton Humelin. He was born in Turku in 1823 and moved to Rauma in 1843. While living in the house on Isopoikkikatu, he ran a bakery shop. He really was sickly; it is known that he was humpbacked. Although Humelin was the city’s only baker, he was starving. Raumans baked the bread they needed at home, and there was not really demand for wheat. Humelin died of pneumonia in 1869. In the same house, baker and brick manufacturer I. V. Grönfors-Koskela continued business. The author Unto Koskela’s memorial plaque is on the house’s exterior wall. The building is no longer a bakery but is used as a crafts shop.

⁶ Now the Kirkkopuisto neighborhood in Rauma.



Figure 1: Anders Anton Kringel's house on the corner of Isopoikkikatu and Kuninkaankatu.

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Appendix A. Antonim bäev

Mnää muista viäl valla hyvin dämäm bäevä, Antonim bäevä, nelikymmend aastaikka takasi. Sillo el viäl — helkkris nii — ja elä viäläkki Anders Anton Kringelin. Hän asus siihe aikka Isollp Poikkiskadull vastpää Simeli ja ol hausk miäs, vaikk olikin givuloine. Antonim bäev ol sinä vuank keskviikko päevän. Tiista ehtost tlee Tasala Vilkk mnuun dyän ja sano:

"Kuulestis, niingos tiädä o huame Antonim bäev ja Kringelinin darvittis herättä huamelтта vähä juhhlisemin gon davalist."

— Tarvittis mar niingi, — oleks ajatell, millaills se tapaduis. — Soittas semsis toimituksis pruukata ja jos Hakkri Iiro puhalais klanettias ja snää krahnaif fiooli, niin gyll mar siit jo koko juhl tliis.

Mutt ei mnuum duuman Vilkuulk kelvann. Se poik pan ai asjak kunnthohon doiselltt tavallk kon davalise ihmse, ja tuski mnää oli saanns sanotuks, millaill mnää ajattlin Gringelini herättämist, ennengo hän rupes kattlema mnuu niingon girko vaevast ja sanos: "Soitta! — soiteta oikke semsis menois; soiteta ja päristellä. Mutt tykkäks snää, ett se o juhhlalist. Ei yhtikäm behu. Toist se on go ammuta ja mnää olengi ajatell, ett Kringelin herätetäm barill laukauksell huame aamust."

— No niin, gyll se vaam bäis käy. Ammuta vaa. Mutt mistäst mek kaikk saam byssy? Em mnää vaa sunkkan dulf föleihi, jos snää yksnäs päräyttlep pyssyines, mnää tahdo amppuk kans ja kyll mnää sengin diädä, ett Hakkri Iiro ja ampput tahto, kon gerra ambumisen doimeis olla.

— Ol vai olk, kukast täsä pyssyst om buhell ja pyssyj ajatell. Tykkäks snää, ett se olis juhhlalist, jos joku snuu nimipäevälläs tliis akknas allp pyssyllp paukuttleema? Takkaks, ettäs heräisi haulpyssym bräiskäyksest?

— Engöst mahdais sendä herät? Mutt Herra nimes, milläst mes sitt ammu, jousei pyssyill?

— Mill me ammu? — Kanuunallt tiätyste; eik siint tarvita Iiroj eik Aaroj; mes saa sen gahden doime valla hyvi. Snää laita Minervan ganuuna huamelтта aikasin dänn ja ko mnää se lada, ni mnää takka, ett se käy kolmest pyssyst ja ussemastakkin, go se lauasta. Tiädäks se om boikka se Minervan ganuun; mnää ole sill ennengi jyräytell.

— No om mar snuull vaan goeran guri, mutt ei snuu meiningis hulluma ol. Ja kyll mnää kanuunan dänn toimita hyvis ajois. Ko ensmäine lehterkuarm mene haminaha huame aamust, ni mnää hyppän guarmam bääll, mene Minervaham, bistän ganuuna säkkihi ja pääsen dalomboja heosell haminast kotti jällk kanuunoinen. Se käy niingo äksäst vaa.

Ja nii mnää teingi. Minervan ganuun ol meill jo enne viitt seoravan aamun ja Vilkk rupes koht ladamisen doimeihi. Kruutti se poik ajo sinnp piolissi, ni ett mnää jo pakkasin dyyreksymän goko juhhlalisutt ja kruutim bäälls se hakkas ja mänttäs rohtmi, nii ettei sill oli mittä määrä. Kyll mnää händ koiti hillitäkki, mutt luulettak, ett se mittä autt. Ei maare; se hakkas vaa vasarall ja puumbalikallt topningeitas kanuunaha ja sylk ai joukko, ett kummingim biukka olis menn. — Em mnää olp pali kanuuna ladamisen doimeis oll, mutt kyll mnää se sendä ymmärsi, ett siit juhhlalinem baukaus pit tleeman, go se lauasti, se Vilku lading. Sill ett kruutti siin ol, niingo sanott, oikkem Borvo mitall ja topningeit Vilkk ol hakanns se juur jämt täytte suuhu saakk. Olsitt nähnk, kuit tytyväise näköne Vilkk ol, ko hän ol saannt tyäs valmiks. Häne silmäs kiilsiväp pääs juur niingon dinaknapik, ko hän viäl kerran goitt sormellas, ett olik rohtmep piukas. Ja sitt hän siäppas koko rustingin gainlohos ja me läksin dosa pual kuude aikka aamustem bainaman Gringelinin dyä. Hissuksis me liikusi ja pääsin göökkihi, nii ettei Anton tiätänn mistä. Kuultti vaan, gom boik kuarsas toises huanes. Koko talos ei oli liikkell viäl kukka muu kom biik. Se ol tehn valu takkaha ja pelas siink kaffepannuines. Mutt mnää sanosi händ: "Kuulestis fliikk, menestis hiukam bois tiäld siitt muuri viärest, meill on däsä kans piänd toimitust."

Kyll piik meit vähäm bitkäst katos, mutt men se sitt sendäm bois muuri viärest, nii ett Vilkk pääs kanuunatas panema laillsse asenttoho siihen dakall. Kaua hän stää siins sovitteli ja justeeras, mutt viime se ol häne miälestäs hyvim baikallas ja mnää sano se, ett se näytt oike juhhlaliseld, ko se siin makas takalls suu päi Antoni huanett. Eik nys sitt tarvitt enä muut ko ruvet laukasemisen doimeihi. Mnää ajattli itteksen, ett kyll mar Vilkk sen gunnjan dahto ittelles, ko hän se ol ladannukki ja muutongi ol semnem byssmiäs. Eng mnää tahdk kiälttä, ett mnää hiukam belkäsingi stää kanuunam bahust ja siirsingi ittiän vähitelle ovem bualehem biika seljän daa. Mutt em mnää siälls saannk kaua seisso. Vilkk ott pärehe valu, tul mnuun dyän ja sanos: "Jaaha, Kalkke, snää joudak kyll nähds sem biäne vaeva, ettäs laukset tuan, go mnää ole se ladinkkin doimittan."

Mnää ymmärsin gyll, ettei täsä ollk kysymyst vaevoist, muttko ett Vilkk pelkäs ja, niingo sanott, pelkäsi mnää, pahus soikko, ittekin goko rustinkki. Mutt samas silmäräpäykses mnää muistin, gui mnää oli maistraati edes saannk kehumist rohkeudestan, gon oli oli valu samottamas, sillon go engelsman Rauma haminam bolt. Ja ko mnää se muisti, ni mnää puri hammastan, graappasim bäresoito Vilkun gädest ja sohasi sillf fänkpannuhu. — —

Sillo se paukatt! — Jumalist, ko se paukatt! — Kyll se ol juhhlalinen däreys! Kaffepann lens, jumal tiäs, mihi, piik seisos silmä riipi raapim bääs eik saanns sanaka ulos suustas ja kaikk akknat talos krapisivap palasiks. Mutt Vilkk siäppas vähä äkkin ganuunan gainlohos ja kas näi lykkämäm bakko, Vilkk edell ja mnää peräs. Ja ko me olim bääs ulos portist, ni me huamasi, ett naaprisakki oliva akkna rikk. Ko mes se näi, ni meillt tul viäl suureve kiiru. Mnää katosi sendän daanen ja sillo mnää näin Gringelinim bistäväm bääs ulos tyhjist akkumboogist ja mek kuulin go hän huus: "Kyll mnää teijä vaa nää, junkkri." — Em mes sendä ollk kuulevannas, kon garasim Balotondi makasiinetten daam biiloho.

Mutt kyll se Vilkk ol aika poik! Ja hyvä kurssi ei meild kummaldakkam buuttunn, vaikk se itt sano. — Arvakkast mitä met tei? Jiiu, ladattin ganuun uudestas ja ko se ol saatt kunttoho — se Vilkk ol siint toimes koko mestar — ni menttin doinen gert Gringelinin dyäm, banttin ganuun vanhalla paikalles ja jyskäytetti uus kert. Mutt se jälkke em me enä lykänn liässuhun go meni sisäll Anttonin gousill. Ja hyvin Gringelin meit trahteeras ja kiit meit vähä mond kertta juhlalisest herätyksest. Ja juhlaliset täräykse ne olivakki. Niin gaikk tykkäsiväk, ko olivak kuuli ne.

Nii händ, muista mar mnää sem bäeva. Se ol siihe aikkan, go viäl sai vähä lystiäkkim bittä. Mutt menkkäst tähä aika mailma panema jotta juhlalisemppa toime, ni ovaf fiskaali ja poliisik koht kimbusan.

Appendix B. Rauma Grammar

End Elision

For two syllable words, if the first syllable is long, the last vowel is removed. For several syllable words, the last vowel is almost always removed. Proper nouns have a lot of exceptions. A syllable is long if it has a long vowel *suu*, diphthong *lae* or if it ends in a consonant *kat*.

Esim. Kyll klapplakk nätt lakk on, go vaa o nätt klapplakk. Tasala Vilkk, Hakkri Iiro.

Internal Elision

The vowel from the second syllable of three or more syllable words is removed if the first syllable is long and the third syllable starts with a consonant *l*, *m*, *n*, *r*, or *v*. Internal elision also occurs in some frequentative verbs.

Esim. Tleestis akknast kattleman gom bappla mukulat tapplevak kartnoll makkran gapplest. Hek kuulustleva, ihmettlevä, ajattleva.

Fast Spoken Forms

The verb *tulla* (to come) has fast spoken forms. Some pronouns also have a fast spoken form.

Esim. Mnää tlee (tlii), snää tlee (tlii), hän tlee, met tlee (tlii), tet tleett (tliitt), het tleeva (tliiva).

Lisäksi vielä sanotaan; stää (sitä).

Vowel Shortening

Long vowels are shortened after the first syllable. The long vowel of the first syllable can also be shortened.

Esim. Totus (totuus), rehelisys (rehellisyys), ihmeline (ihmeellinen), tytyväine (tyytyväinen), jähty (jäähtyä).

Southwestern Dialect Special Gemination

The letters K, T, P, and S from inside of words are lengthened before a long syllable, and the long syllable is shortened at the same time. There is not always gemination in the third person singular.

Esim. Ostakka lissä leippä ja maitto. Antakka ruakka. Hän teke, hän pese, hän makka, hän putto.

Poikkeuksellisesti myös; täyty sanno.

K, T, and P After Nasal Consonants

K, T, and P after N (and often T after L) turn into approximately G, D, and B respectively. For instance, in old Rauma K is pronounced somewhere between K and G. Hj. Nortamo and several other Rauma authors describe this “softening” by writing G, D, and B in place of K, T, and P after N. These should not be pronounced as they are. The correct pronunciation is closer to K, T, and P. Also N before P changes to M. When G, D, and B appear inside of a word, they are pronounced as they are.

Esim. Tliin dännekkinn gattlema. Om baheve kom beto. Rauman ganal. Oi voi sendä. Jumal andakko.

The Rauma D

Apparently due to Swedish influence, the letter D appears in standard Rauma. In other southwestern dialects, its equivalent is pronounced roughly as R. Weaker forms may also be used.

Esim. Sydämen gyllydest suu puhu. Sado (satoi), kaadus (kaatui), mahdaisik (mahtaisiko).

Diphthong Expansion

YÖ, IE, and UO are expanded.

Esim. tyämiäs tiana nuarenakki. Siällt taikk tuall, ai väärällp puall.

Diphthong Reduction

Diphthongs ending in U, Y, and I in the first syllable are replaced with O, Ö, and E if the following syllable begins with D, R, L, H, or V but the closest vowel is not U, Y, or I.

Esim. u → o: laoda (laudat), naora (nauraa), paoha (pauhaa)

y → ö: pöödäll (pöydällä), nöör (nöyrä), kööh (köyhä)

i → e: paeda (paidat), saeras (sairas), laev (laiva), päev (päivä)

The IE diphthong changes to IÄ if the word is a single syllable, or if in a several syllable word the following syllable does not have other vowels besides I or E.

Esim. tiä, viäl, viäres

The IE diphthong may also change to IA.

Esim. viaras, tiadoi, hianomppi

The Final N

The final N is removed except before K, T, and P.

Esim. Meijä heone, meijän goto, meijäm boik.

The Final T

The final T is removed except if the following word begins with K, T, P, S, or F, in which case the consonant is repeated at the end of the word. These consonants are sometimes repeated elsewhere.

Esim. Poja oliva ilossi, mutt pojak kyll olsivap pistänt tupakiks, flikat tahdosivaf fölihi.

Double M, N, R and L

Double M, N, R, and L are often shortened.

Esim. mnää käänä (käännän), uudema (uudemman), maaline (maallinen), ymmäräks (ymmärräks).

The Rauma Illative

The illative case in Rauma is like the following:

Esim. kirjaha, taloho, kaupunkkihi

The ending is only on the main word and not on previous modifiers.

Esim. häne sanomissihis, punasse aittaha

There are also some forms without endings.

Esim. Iiro putos mere_. Paatt men hukka_.

The Plural Genitive

Mixed forms occur in the genitive plural.

Esim. poikkatte, poikkitte, pojitte, flikkatte, äijätte.

The Imperfect

The SI ending often appears in the imperfect tense.

Esim. mnää istusi, nukusi.

Comparative Adjectives

The comparative most often takes the VE ending. The superlative uses the words *kaikkist* or *kaikke*. The VE form is usually not declined further.

Esim. Isove, kauneve, kivave, vanheve. Kaikken gauneve, kaikkist isove.

The MP ending is still used.

Esim. punasemp, paremp, falskemp, fiinemp, pimiämp. Kaikkest suuremp.

The Common TS

The equivalent of TS in Rauma is TT, which varies with T.

Esim. Älkkän gattok, mnää kato, mettä, metäs.

Inessive Ending

Although words often end in two consonants, the inessive case uses just one.

Esim. talos, paatis, rannas, fundeeramises, punases

Consonants at the Beginning of Words

Loan words often have two or even three consonants at the beginning.

Esim. skriiva, frääkät, kröhä, flatkutta

The Common HT

HT after the first syllable changes to TT and sometimes T.

Esim. tapattu, tapatus, humatta, paukatta

This change does not usually occur in loan words.

Esim. tirehtöör, karahtäärat

Dental Fricatives

The letters TT and their softened form T are pronounced as a voiceless dental fricative like in *think*. The softened form of T is pronounced as a voiced dental fricative like in *there*.

The Internal V

The letter V in a word's second syllable is often dropped, unless it is followed by the vowels O, U, or Y.

Esim. heone, papu → paus, sau, siu, väy

The Internal J

Two syllable words with a J before the final vowel often changes to an I, and the final vowel is dropped.

Esim. lahja → lahi, marja → mari, harja → hari, kirja → kiri, karja → kari

Adessive and Allative

Both the adessive and the allative cases have the same form due to end elision.

Esim. laattjall = lattialla / lattialle, kartnoll = pihamaalla / pihamalle

Partitive

The partitive ending is shortened from a long vowel to a short vowel.

Esim. ruakka

Some words use a T as a partitive ending

Esim. lirot, autot

Words that end in EA or EÄ in standard Finnish take I endings.

Esim. henkeä → henkki, suomea → suami

The Internal and Final I

The vowel I is often dropped from nouns ending in -inen, with notable exceptions.

Esim. punane, valkone, kulttane, raumlaine, yksnäine

In several words, the final I is changed to an E.

Esim. kauniste, jänekse

-llinen to -loine

The -loine suffix resembles the southwestern dialectal variation of -llinen, which is common in adjectives.

Esim. ihmeellinen → ihmeloine, kivullinen → kivuloine

-(s)tis Clitic

These suffixes do not drastically change the meaning but add an informal emphasis.

Esim. mitästis → mitä(pä)s, kuulestis → kuule(pa)s, menestis → mene(pa)s

Comitative

The comitative case takes the ending -ines.

Esim. kaffepannuines, pyssyines